Jews throughout history were created by Jehovah long before they were born and all these souls were present at Mount Sinai.[10] As Salvador Litvak, a Jewish social media influencer, explained to his online followers in 2018, 'You and I were there together … When we fulfill the obligation to see ourselves as if we personally left Egypt, it's not a metaphor. We don't imagine the Exodus, we remember it.'[11]

So every year, in the most important celebration of the Jewish calendar, millions of Jews put on a show that they remember things that they didn't witness and that probably never happened at all. As numerous modern studies indicate, repeatedly retelling a fake memory eventually causes the person to adopt it as a genuine recollection.[12] When two Jews encounter each other for the first time, they can immediately feel that they both belong to the same family, that they were together as slaves in Egypt, and that they were together at Mount Sinai. That's a powerful bond that has sustained the Jewish network over many centuries and continents.

INTERSUBJECTIVE ENTITIES

The Jewish Passover story builds a large network by taking existing biological kin bonds and stretching them. It creates an imagined family of millions. But there is an even more revolutionary way for stories to build networks. Like DNA, stories can create new entities. Indeed, stories can even create an entirely new level of reality. As far as we know, prior to the emergence of stories the universe contained just two levels of reality. Stories added a third.

The two levels of reality that preceded storytelling are objective reality and subjective reality. *Objective reality* consists of things like stones, mountains and asteroids – things that exist whether we are aware of them or not. An asteroid hurtling toward planet Earth, for example, exists even if nobody knows it's out there. Then there is *subjective reality:* things like pain, pleasure and love that aren't 'out there' but rather 'in here'. Subjective things exist in our awareness of them. An unfelt ache is an oxymoron.

But some stories are able to create a third level of reality: *intersubjective reality*. Whereas subjective things like pain exist in a single mind, intersubjective things like laws, gods, nations, corporations and currencies exist in the nexus between large numbers of minds. More specifically, they